

Anthony Jonathan Maldonado

Gameplay Developer | Technical Designer | Game Designer

ajm4559@g.rit.edu | 718-749-7555 | www.linkedin.com/in/ajm4559 | ajsgottheway.itch.io

SUMMARY

I am a Game Design and Development graduate from Rochester Institute of Technology with interest and experience designing gameplay systems, combat mechanics, narrative tools, user interfaces, levels, VR interactions, and web applications across collaborative and independent projects. Skilled in Unity, Godot, Unreal, C#, C++, SQL, and Ink, with a focus on translating design goals into playable, maintainable systems..

EDUCATION

Rochester Institute of Technology (RIT)
Bachelor of Science, Game Design and Development

May 2026
Rochester, NY

EXPERIENCE

Web Development Intern
The Rockefeller University

July 2026 - Present
New York, NY

- Develop and maintain web applications while expanding proficiency in PHP, SQL, Apache, and Unix/Linux environments.
- Collaborate with the IT team to learn and apply professional web development practices, coding standards, and development workflows.
- Build and refine database-driven web functionality using PHP and SQL, including form processing, data validation, and CRUD operations.

Game Developer
CATMONKEY Studios

August 2025 - Present
Los Angeles, CA

- Currently designing and implementing combat systems for The GATEWAY Project's 3D FPS section, including player movement, aiming and shooting, weapon handling, enemy encounters, and combat feedback.
- Prototype mechanics in Unity, test individual combat components, and refine pacing and responsiveness through team feedback and playtesting.
- Collaborate with developers and narrative contributors to connect FPS encounters with the game's transition from 2D horror-puzzle gameplay.

IT Intern
Cipriani

June 2025 - August 2025
New York, NY

- Designed anti-phishing awareness campaigns and used Barracuda to identify and mitigate email threats.
- Resolved employee hardware, software, account-access, and phishing issues through the Zoho ticketing system.
- Supported workstation and network setup through cabling, Ethernet crimping, equipment deployment, and legacy hardware removal.

Game Developer
Changeling

May 2024 - August 2024
Rochester, NY

- Designed a playable level around player navigation, encounter pacing, environmental storytelling, and progression.
- Co-led the level's narrative team, coordinating story implementation and design decisions across contributors.
- Developed and tested enemy AI behavior while collaborating with designers and developers to align narrative events, level structure, and gameplay objectives.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: C#, C++, Python, JavaScript, GDScript, PHP, SQL, HTML, CSS

Engines & Frameworks: Unity, Godot, Unreal Engine, MonoGame, Ink

Game Development: Gameplay Programming, Combat Design, Dialogue Systems, Narrative Design, Level Design, UI/UX Design, VR Development, 2D/3D Asset Integration

Web & Systems: Apache, Unix/Linux

Tools & Workflow: Visual Studio Code, Maya, Photoshop, Figma, Trello, Barracuda, Zoho, Scrum, Agile Development, Project Management, iOS

PROJECTS

The GATEWAY Project
Unity | 2D Horror Puzzle Adventure transitioning into a 3D FPS

September 2025 - Present

- Built an Ink-driven dialogue system in Unity supporting branching choices, speaker identification, character portraits, and controlled dialogue progression.
- Implemented speaker-specific UI that changes panel placement, text orientation, font color, portrait layouts, and choice-button positioning based on the active character.
- Refactored the initial implementation into modular, reusable components so new speakers, styles, portraits, and dialogue content can be added without rewriting the core logic.
- Integrated dialogue triggers and player choices with scene progression throughout the 2D horror-puzzle portion of the game.

Hardline VR
Godot | VR Hack n Slash Action Game

March 2026

- Designed and built a first-person VR hack-and-slash, including the environment, combat systems, weapons, and destructible enemy effects.
- Designed the main level layout and combat environment around fast-paced movement and close-range encounters.
- Created breakable environmental interactions, including shattering windows and destructible improvised weapons, and implemented firearms and a sledgehammer for VR use with smooth Meta Quest 3S controller locomotion.
- Created the game's background music.

Intergalactic Ducky
Godot | 3D Isometric Adventure Game

November 2024

- Designed the primary level layout using landmarks, obstacle placement, and progression beats to guide players through the isometric environment.
- Iterated on navigation and gameplay flow with teammates during a limited development period; the project received the HACK.COMS 2024 Best Game Award.
- Coordinated level-design decisions with the team so objectives, obstacles, and environmental cues reinforced the intended player route.

Bionaut
Unity | 2D Top-Down Space Exploration Game

December 2024

- Designed the main level and exploration route around collecting alien companions needed to progress toward the player's return home.
- Placed objectives, environmental features, and collectible encounters to support pacing, navigation, and player discovery.

Twelve Mage
MonoGame | Top-Down Fantasy Wave Shooter

December 2023

- Implemented core combat systems in C# and MonoGame for a wave-based fantasy shooter.
- Added visual feedback for attacks and enemy hits to improve combat readability and responsiveness.

ADDITIONAL EMPLOYMENT

RIT Catering
Rochester Institute of Technology

January 2025 - May 2026
Rochester, NY

Leasing Specialist
APEX

May 2024 - August 2024
Rochester, NY

AWARDS & ACTIVITIES

- HACK.COMS 2024 Best Game - Intergalactic Ducky
- RIT Performing Arts Scholarship Recipient
- Dean's List Recipient
- RIT GameDevClub Member